

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1097

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Chief John Linsenbigler, longtime officer with the Seymour Volunteer Fire Department, on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those Tennesseans who have performed with uncommon devotion and ability throughout their careers in public service; and

WHEREAS, one such outstanding person is John Linsenbigler, who took a well-earned retirement on April 1, 2026, after a distinguished forty-four-year career in the fire service; and

WHEREAS, for thirty years, he served as a vitally important officer with the Seymour Volunteer Fire Department (SVFD) and astutely served as its chief and executive officer for the past seven years; and

WHEREAS, after moving to Seymour in 1980, John Linsenbigler started his fire career as a reserve firefighter for Rural Metro Fire in 1982 and then began working on Rural Metro ambulances in 1985; and

WHEREAS, in 1989, he transferred to Johnson Bible College's Fire Brigade, and he began a seventeen-year tenure as the college's fire chief in 1995; and

WHEREAS, because of an ongoing partnership with the college, SVFD hired Mr. Linsenbigler to oversee a grant in 1996, and a long and mutually beneficial relationship was established; and

WHEREAS, John Linsenbigler proceeded to climb the SVFD leadership ladder, earning promotion to lieutenant in 1999, captain in 2004, assistant chief in 2008, deputy chief in 2010, and in 2017 he became the chief; and

WHEREAS, John Linsenbigler has always been a servant-leader, focusing on the welfare of his fellow human beings and community care, and he has utilized a hands-on

approach to his leadership of SVFD, including delivering a baby and providing comfort to a burn victim; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Linsenbigler's retirement coincided with SVFD's fifty-fifth anniversary as a community fire agency; the proud legacy he has left behind includes six stations and seventy-eight firefighters (with seven applicants pending) who serve some 16,000 households, responding to 3,229 emergency calls in 2025 alone; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Linsenbigler plans to continue his community service as a substitute teacher with the Sevier County school system; and

WHEREAS, he and his family express their faith as members of Seymour Heights Christian Church; and

WHEREAS, his many personal and professional accomplishments aside, John Linsenbigler is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his wife of forty-five years, Carol, a teacher with more than twenty years of experience; and

WHEREAS, the Linsenbiglers have been blessed with two children, Rebecca and Adam, and two granddaughters; and

WHEREAS, John Linsenbigler has been a visionary and compassionate leader during his tenure with the Seymour Volunteer Fire Department, and he should be specially recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Chief John Linsenbigler upon his exemplary thirty years of service to the Seymour Volunteer Fire Department, salute his ongoing commitment to his community and its safety, and extend to him our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.